

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Data refutes ‘worst of worst’ claim



U.S. Border Patrol agents exchange handcuffs for plastic zip ties while transferring detainees they picked up landscaping on Chicago's Northwest Side into a van in Niles during immigration enforcement operations on Oct. 31. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Only 2.6% on list of 614 Chicagoland immigration arrestees have criminal histories, records reveal

By Jason Meisner, Madeline Buckley, Gregory Royal Pratt, Rebecca Johnson and Laura Rodríguez Presa | Chicago Tribune

The Trump administration on Friday released the names of 614 people whose Chicago-area immigration arrests may have violated a 2022 consent decree, and only 16 of them have criminal histories that present a “high public safety risk.”

The list was produced as part of an ongoing lawsuit alleging immigration agents have repeatedly violated the terms of the in-court settlement, mostly during Operation Midway Blitz, that puts a high bar on making so-called warrantless arrests without a prior warrant or probable cause.

The Department of Homeland Security has claimed since the outset of the operation that they were going after the “worst of the worst,” including convicted murderers, rapists and other violent offenders who were allegedly taking advantage of Illinois’ sanctuary policies to terrorize the citizenry.

But the government’s own data, provided in a filing posted to the public docket Friday, appeared to show otherwise. Of the 16 arrestees

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INSIDE ICE shooting video released

The Chicago Police Department on Friday released 13 heavily redacted body camera videos depicting the initial response to a crash and shooting in Brighton Park involving federal immigration agents that ended in tear gas. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

■ 21 people were arrested during a protest Friday outside the ICE facility in Broadview following a skirmish with officers. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

Trump turning focus to economy

New proposals come amid high costs and growing pessimism

By Alan Rappeport
The New York Times

WASHINGTON — Lower prices for coffee and fruit. A 50-year mortgage to reduce monthly home payments. Direct checks of \$2,000 to many Americans. And a new willingness to welcome skilled foreign labor into the United States.

The Trump administration has floated a series of ideas over the past several weeks as it confronts the cold reality that its economic policies are not helping many Americans who continue to struggle with elevated prices and a sense of economic pessimism.

Last week’s elections made clear that affordability was top of mind for many Americans. Voters in New York propelled Zohran Mamdani, the democratic socialist with an ambitious agenda to lower the cost of living, to victory in the mayoral race. Democratic wins in New Jersey and Virginia were built on promises to address the high cost of living in those states.

Only 30% of voters believe President Donald Trump has lived up to their expectations for tackling inflation and the cost of living, according to a recent NBC News poll. That was his lowest mark for any issue respondents were asked about. And a meager 27% of voters in a CNN poll in late October said Trump’s policies had improved the country’s economic conditions — less than half of those who thought he had made matters worse.

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ELECTION 2026 US SENATE



U.S. Reps. Robin Kelly, left, and Raja Krishnamoorthi, center, along with Illinois Lt. Gov. Juliana Stratton participate in a candidates forum for their U.S. Senate race at IBEW Local 134 in Chicago on Thursday. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Dem hopefuls attack Trump on immigration, affordability

At forum, candidates vow to hold administration accountable for its actions

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

The three major candidates seeking the Democratic nomination for the U.S. Senate in March each used a union forum Thursday night to pledge their fealty to organized labor and vowed to hold President Donald Trump accountable if elected.

Speaking at an event hosted

by the Illinois AFL-CIO and the Chicago Federation of Labor, Lt. Gov. Juliana Stratton and U.S. Reps. Raja Krishnamoorthi and Robin Kelly each blamed Trump for voter concerns over affordability, a winning strategy among Democrats in off-year elections nationally earlier this month.

But they also attacked Trump’s immigration enforcement policies and the aggressive tactics of

U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement and Border Patrol agents in Operation Midway Blitz, saying they would pursue comprehensive reform while pushing the administration to answer for its actions.

Stratton, the two-term lieutenant governor under Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker, sought to portray herself as the outsider against the Washington “status

quo” of her two rivals, who now serve in Congress.

“I can tell you that this is a time where we need real fighters,” Stratton told the audience of union members at the headquarters of the International Brotherhood of Electrical Workers Local 134 in Bronzeville.

“The people are showing us

Turn to Senate, Page 2



Ald. Pat Dowell, 3rd, chair of the Finance Committee, talks to reporters on Oct. 16 in City Council chambers after Mayor Brandon Johnson delivered his budget address at City Hall. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

CHICAGO CITY BUDGET

Finance chair calls vote ‘premature’

Key alderman warns mayor that head tax plan is nonstarter ahead of Monday committee hearing

By Alice Yin and A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson began hedging Friday on whether his 2026 budget will see its first vote next week, following his Finance Committee chair publicly targeting his controversial head tax as a nonstarter with her.

Ald. Pat Dowell, 3rd, told reporters after weeks of budget hearings for Johnson’s \$16.6 billion spend-

ing plan concluded Thursday that she advised the Johnson administration not to proceed with a vote in her committee Monday. But she stopped short of saying she would try to block a vote should the mayor proceed regardless.

“I think going on Monday is premature. I have said that to the administration,” Dowell said. “My role as the Finance chair is to give advice, and on Monday I’m going to have a meeting, and those things

will either be on the agenda or they won’t. And I will call balls and strikes, and we’ll see where this goes.”

The fifth-term alderman also came out swinging against Johnson’s \$21-per-employee monthly tax on corporations.

“I am not a supporter of the head tax at any level,” Dowell said when asked if the mayor’s latest proposal bumping the minimum company size up from 100 to 200 workers satisfies her.

It was a remarkable break

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